

Meridian Pet Health Lifetime Policy

Policy Wording v2.3 · Sample document for testing only

Section 1 — Policy Period and Eligibility

- 1.1 Cover applies to the dog or cat named on the schedule for a rolling 12-month policy period, renewable annually for the life of the pet provided cover is not lapsed.
- 1.2 The pet must be between 8 weeks and 8 years of age at first inception and must be microchipped and registered at the insured address.
- 1.3 Policy numbers for this product are in the format PH-XXXXXXX (e.g. PH-7720419).
- 1.4 A waiting period of 14 days applies to illness cover and 48 hours to accident cover from the inception date. Conditions first showing symptoms during the waiting period are treated as pre-existing.

Section 2 — Covered Treatment

- 2.1 Veterinary fees for the treatment of an accidental injury or illness first occurring during the policy period.
- 2.2 Diagnostic tests, imaging, surgery, hospitalisation, prescribed medication and follow-up consultations relating to a covered condition.
- 2.3 Complementary treatment (physiotherapy, hydrotherapy, acupuncture) when referred by a vet for a covered condition.
- 2.4 Dental treatment resulting from an accident. Dental illness is covered only where a dental check has been carried out within the 12 months before the claim.
- 2.5 Third-party liability for injury or property damage caused by an insured dog.
- 2.6 Advertising and reward costs if the pet is lost or stolen, and the purchase price if not recovered within 30 days.
- 2.7 Death from injury or illness before the pet's 9th birthday: the purchase price of the pet.

Section 3 — Exclusions

- 3.1 Pre-existing conditions: any illness or injury, or symptom of one, that occurred or was noticed before the inception date or during the waiting period, and any related or bilateral condition.
- 3.2 Routine and preventative treatment: vaccinations, flea and worm control, neutering, nail clipping, grooming and routine dental scaling.
- 3.3 Pregnancy, breeding, whelping and any complications thereof.
- 3.4 Behavioural conditions unless treated by a referred veterinary behaviourist and shown as covered on the schedule.
- 3.5 Prescription diets and food, except for 50% of the cost when prescribed for a covered urinary or digestive condition for a maximum of 3 months.
- 3.6 Treatment for conditions arising from a failure to follow veterinary advice or to keep vaccinations current.
- 3.7 Dogs of a breed listed under the Dangerous Dogs Act of the country of residence, or used for racing, guarding or commercial breeding.

3.8 Costs incurred after the policy has lapsed or been cancelled, even where the condition began during the policy period.

Section 4 — Deductible (Excess)

4.1 A fixed excess of 99 applies once per condition per policy year.

4.2 For pets aged 8 years or over at the start of the policy year, a co-payment of 20% of the remaining claim applies in addition to the fixed excess.

4.3 No excess applies to the third-party liability, advertising and reward, or death benefit sections.

Section 5 — Limits and Sub-limits

5.1 Veterinary fees: up to 7,000 per policy year, refreshing at each renewal. Unused amounts do not carry forward.

5.2 Complementary treatment: sub-limit 750 per policy year within the veterinary fees limit.

5.3 Dental treatment: sub-limit 1,000 per policy year within the veterinary fees limit.

5.4 Third-party liability (dogs only): up to 1,000,000 per incident.

5.5 Advertising and reward: up to 250; purchase price if not found: up to 1,500.

5.6 Death benefit: purchase price up to 1,500, reducing to 0 from the pet's 9th birthday.

5.7 Emergency boarding fees if the policyholder is hospitalised for more than 4 consecutive days: up to 500 per policy year.

Section 6 — Claim Conditions

6.1 Claims must be submitted within 90 days of the treatment date on the insurer's claim form, with the treating vet's section completed.

6.2 A full clinical history from every practice that has treated the pet is required for the first claim on each new condition.

6.3 Itemised invoices are required. Where the vet's fees are, in the insurer's reasonable opinion, higher than customary in the area, the insurer may settle at the customary amount.

6.4 For the lost or stolen pet benefit, the loss must be reported to the local police, the microchip database and a local animal shelter within 48 hours.

6.5 Third-party liability incidents must be reported within 7 days and no admission of liability may be made without the insurer's written consent.

6.6 A post-mortem report may be requested before the death benefit is paid.

6.7 Direct payment to the vet is available only where the practice has agreed in advance and the claim exceeds 300.

Section 7 — Fraud

7.1 Fraudulent or exaggerated claims, including altered invoices or clinical records, void all benefit under this policy and the policy is cancelled from the date of the fraudulent act.